

Infosys Springboard Virtual Internship 7.0

Milestone – 4 Report

Team Details: Team D

Batch Number: Batch – 1, Group - 1

Start Date: 29/06/2026

Names: Vennela Pathipaka, Subhashree Subhasmita, Tejasri Lakshmi Maddula, Twinkle Mohanty.

Internship Duration: 8 Weeks

Mentor Name: Mrs. Nithyasree

1. Project Title

“ Cyber Threat Analytics Platform with Incident Visualization System Group 1 ”

This project aims to analyze cybersecurity incidents and convert complex data into actionable insights using interactive Power BI dashboards and advanced visualization techniques.

2. Project Objective

The objective of this project phase is to understand the cybersecurity dataset, connect it with Power BI, perform data preprocessing by handling missing values, removing duplicates, and correcting data types, and prepare a clean and structured dataset for creating meaningful visualizations and supporting cybersecurity incident analysis. Specifically, the project aimed to:

- Explore the structure, coverage, and quality of a raw cybersecurity incident dataset.
- Identify and quantify data-quality issues, especially missing values.
- Characterize the dataset along multiple dimensions — action, actor origin, motive, geography, asset type, and time — before any cleaning was applied.
- Design a cleaning strategy appropriate to each column's data type and meaning.
- Encode categorical fields into numeric form suitable for downstream analysis.
- Scale numeric fields onto a common range.
- Validate that the final dataset is complete, consistent, and analysis-ready.
- Surface practical limitations of the pipeline and recommend next steps for analysts who will use the cleaned dataset.

3. Project Description

3.1 Overview

This project focused on analysing a cybersecurity incident dataset using Power BI. The dataset was connected to Power BI, where preprocessing tasks such as handling missing values, removing duplicate records, correcting data types, and cleaning irrelevant data were performed to improve data quality. The processed dataset was then prepared for visualization, enabling meaningful analysis of cyber threats, attack patterns, affected countries, and incident trends. The project provides a structured foundation for creating interactive dashboards that support cybersecurity monitoring and data-driven decision-making.

3.2 Project Approach

The project followed a systematic eight-step workflow, moving from problem framing through to a published, interactive report. The stages that were actually carried out are described below; the diagram illustrates how each stage feeds into the next.

1. Problem Understanding

The project objectives for Milestone 3 were reviewed to understand the requirement of extending the existing cybersecurity dashboards with additional interactive visualizations.

2. Data Collection

Gathered the raw incident dataset (result.csv, 10,228 rows × 21 columns) and profiled its structure, grouping fields conceptually into incident identity, how the incident happened, who was involved, the affected asset, and where/when it occurred.

3. Data Understanding

Exploratory checks revealed hacking and human error as the dominant recorded causes, external actors behind just over half of all incidents, and the United States as the most represented victim country.

4. Data Connection

Connected the raw CSV export into a Python/pandas working environment using `pandas.read_csv()`, establishing a single, consistent source of truth before any cleaning began. Column data types and per-column missing-value counts were profiled immediately on load, and the cleaned result was later written back out to `preprocessing_report.xlsx` with separate Preprocessed and Summary sheets.

5. Data Preprocessing

Cleaned, transformed, and prepared the data in four sequential stages: missing-value treatment (matched to each column's data type), categorical encoding (label-encoding every category to a unique integer), feature scaling (min-max normalization of numeric fields to a 0–1 range), and validation (confirming zero missing values and zero dropped records across all 21 columns).

6. Data Modeling

Necessary DAX measures, calculated columns, and relationships were created or refined to enable advanced analysis and improve dashboard performance.

7. Data Visualization

Built five interactive dashboards — Executive Summary, Threat Analysis, Attacker and Actor Intelligence, Target and Asset Vulnerability Analysis, and Impact and Incident Severity — combining KPI cards, charts, maps, matrices, slicers, and treemaps to communicate insights effectively.

8. Share / Publish Report

Compiled the findings, dashboards, and methodology into this milestone report for review by the mentor and stakeholders, making the analysis and its conclusions available for wider use.

3.3 Technology Used

This project was implemented using Microsoft Power BI to analyze and visualize cybersecurity incident data through interactive dashboards. The dataset was imported into Power BI, where Power Query Editor was used for data preparation and validation. DAX (Data Analysis Expressions) was utilized to create calculated measures and support advanced analytical requirements. Various interactive visualizations, including cards, bar charts, column charts, treemaps, maps, funnel charts, ribbon charts, KPI cards, and slicers, were designed to present cybersecurity trends and incident patterns effectively.

Technology/Tool	Purpose
Microsoft Power BI	Dashboard development and data visualization
Power Query Editor	Data preparation and validation
DAX (Data Analysis Expressions)	Creating calculated measures and KPIs
Cybersecurity Incident Dataset (CSV)	Source of cybersecurity incident data
Interactive Visualizations	Displaying trends, attack patterns, and insights
Microsoft Windows	Development environment

3.4 Insights from the Dashboard

The interactive dashboards provided valuable insights into cybersecurity incidents by presenting data in a clear and meaningful manner. The analysis revealed the distribution of cyberattacks across different countries, attack types, attacker origins, asset roles, and time periods. Hacking emerged as one of the most frequently observed attack methods, while external threat actors were responsible for a significant number of incidents. Geographic visualizations highlighted countries with higher incident frequencies, enabling a better understanding of regional cybersecurity risks.

The dashboards also identified trends in attack patterns over time, allowing users to observe changes in incident frequency and the ranking of different attack types. Interactive filters and slicers enabled detailed exploration of the dataset, making it easier to compare multiple categories and identify critical areas requiring attention.

Overall, the dashboards transformed complex cybersecurity data into meaningful visual insights, supporting efficient monitoring, informed decision-making, and strategic planning for improving cybersecurity awareness and incident management.

Web applications are the single most targeted asset type, followed closely by documents and databases, and Adware is the most frequently recorded attack detail.

The overall threat level, based on total recorded incident volume, is classified as CRITICAL, with a sharp increase in incident volume visible in more recent years.

3.5 Real-world Impact for Media and Public Communication

- Improves the understanding of cybersecurity incidents through interactive and easy-to-read dashboards.
- Helps organizations identify cyberattack trends and make informed security decisions.
- Enables quick analysis of attack patterns, targeted countries, and affected assets.
- Supports security teams in monitoring incidents and planning preventive measures.
- Assists media professionals in presenting cybersecurity statistics and trends in a clear visual format.
- Increases public awareness of cybersecurity threats and the importance of digital safety.
- Simplifies complex cybersecurity data, making it understandable for both technical and non-technical audiences.
- Encourages data-driven decision-making by providing accurate and interactive visual insights.
- Enhances communication between organizations, researchers, and stakeholders through meaningful visual reports.
- Contributes to better cybersecurity planning and incident management using business intelligence dashboards.

4. Timeline Overview

Week	Activities Planned	Activities Completed
Week1	Understand project & prepare PPT	Project understanding and PPT completed
Week2	Collect the cybersecurity dataset and perform data preprocessing for visualization.	Collected the dataset, cleaned the data, handled missing values, and prepared it for analysis in Power BI.
Week3	Develop the first two interactive Power BI dashboards.	Designed and completed Dashboard 1 and Dashboard 2 with interactive visualizations and insights.
Week4	Develop three additional Power BI dashboards for enhanced analysis.	Dashboard 3, Dashboard 4 & 5 completed
Week5	Develop two additional Power BI dashboards for advanced threat pattern analysis.	Dashboard 6 and Dashboard 7 completed with visualizations for attack patterns, threat trends, attacker behaviour, asset targeting, and attack motives.
Week6	Analyze, review, and refine Dashboard 6 and Dashboard 7 for better visualization and insight generation.	Reviewed and refined Dashboard 6 and Dashboard 7, improved the visualizations and insights, and ensured that the dashboards effectively represented threat patterns, attack trends, attacker behavior, targeted assets, and attack motives.
Week7	Perform testing, validation, and refinement of all dashboards and visualizations.	Tested all seven dashboards, validated the data and visualizations, checked the accuracy of insights, and refined the dashboards to improve clarity, consistency, and overall usability.
Week8	Complete project documentation and prepare the final presentation.	Completed the project documentation, summarized the methodology and key findings, and prepared the final presentation showcasing all dashboards, analysis, insights, and overall project outcomes.

5a. Key Milestones

Milestone	Description	Date Achieved
Milestone 1	Data Foundation & Preparation – Dataset collection, preprocessing, cleaning, and data validation.	9/06/2026
Milestone 2	Core Dashboard Development – Built the first two interactive Power BI dashboards for cybersecurity analysis.	16/07/2026
Milestone 3	Advanced Visualization & Reporting – Created three additional dashboards, generated insights, and completed project documentation.	23/07/2026
Milestone 4	Created two additional interactive Power BI dashboards to perform deeper cybersecurity threat pattern analysis and generate additional insights.	13/08/2026

Milestone 1:

Identified the cybersecurity analysis problem and defined the main objectives of the project. Collected a suitable cybersecurity incident dataset and studied its structure, attributes, data types, and relevant fields. The dataset was reviewed to understand the information available for further analysis.

Milestone 2:

Imported the collected dataset into Microsoft Power BI and performed data cleaning and transformation using Power Query. Removed unnecessary columns, handled missing values, removed duplicate records, and corrected data types. The cleaned dataset was validated and prepared for visualization and analysis.

Milestone 3:

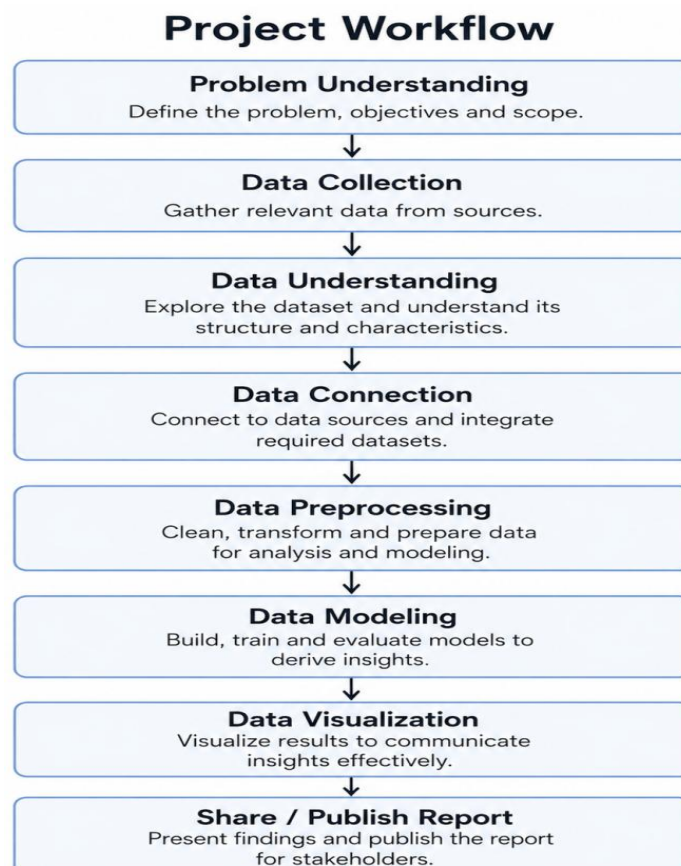
Created the required **data model and DAX measures** to support cybersecurity analysis. Developed the first set of interactive Power BI dashboards using charts, KPI cards, slicers, and other visualizations. Analyzed important aspects such as attack types, attacker countries, targeted assets, and attack motives to generate meaningful insights.

Milestone 4:

Developed two additional Power BI dashboards for deeper cybersecurity analysis. The dashboards focused on attack patterns, threat trends, attacker behaviour, asset targeting, attack techniques, and threat motives. Added interactive filters for attributes such as country and motive, along with different visualizations to identify important patterns and trends. The dashboards were reviewed and refined to ensure clear presentation, accurate results, and useful cybersecurity insights.

5b. Project Execution details

The project was executed by following the Project Workflow shown below end-to-end, moving from problem framing to a published report. Each stage built directly on the output of the one before it, so that the same 10,228 records could be traced consistently from raw import through to the final dashboards. It follows a systematic workflow that ensures data is collected, understood, connected, cleaned, and finally presented in a form ready for modeling and visualization.



1: Problem Understanding

The project objectives and requirements were analyzed to understand the cybersecurity problem and identify the key goals for data analysis and dashboard development.

2: Data Collection

The cybersecurity incident dataset was collected in CSV format from a publicly available source. Before starting the analysis, the dataset was carefully examined to understand its overall structure, including the number of records, columns, and the type of information contained in each attribute. The dataset included details such as actor variety, asset variety, attack motive, attacker country, victim country, attack type, day, month, year, and other incident-related attributes.

The dataset was then explored to identify:

- The total number of rows and columns.
- The purpose of each attribute.
- Numerical, categorical, and date fields.
- Missing (NA) values and unknown entries.
- Unnecessary columns that were not useful for analysis.
- Duplicate or inconsistent records that required cleaning.

3: Data Understanding

The dataset was profiled column by column to understand its structure, data types, and quality before preprocessing. Missing-value analysis identified significant gaps, with `asset_ownership` containing up to 99% missing values. Exploratory analysis also examined the distribution of attack types, actor origins, motives, victim countries, and asset varieties to understand the overall incident landscape prior to data cleaning.

Exploratory analysis revealed that hacking and human error are the most common causes of cybersecurity incidents, followed by misuse and physical actions, while malware and social-engineering attacks are relatively less frequent.

More than half of the incidents originate from external actors, whereas internal actors account for approximately 42% of the total incidents, with partners contributing only a small proportion.

Financial gain is the dominant motive, representing nearly 39% of all incidents. However, the motive is missing or marked as "Unknown" in a significant number of records.

The analysis also shows that the United States accounts for nearly 73% of the victim records, followed by countries such as the United Kingdom, Canada, and Australia. In terms of targeted assets, web applications are the most affected, followed by documents and databases.

4: Data Connection

The collected dataset was imported into Microsoft Power BI Desktop using the Get Data → Text/CSV option. After importing, the dataset was loaded into the Power Query Editor, where the data transformation process was carried out.

- Promoted the first row as column headers.
- Verified and corrected the data types of all attributes.
- Removed unnecessary columns.
- Renamed column names for better readability.
- Cleaned text fields by removing unwanted characters.
- Trimmed extra spaces from text values.
- Standardized text formatting by capitalizing words.
- Replaced invalid or inconsistent values such as NA where required.
- Filtered unwanted rows and retained valid records.
- Reordered and sorted columns to improve dataset organization.

After completing these transformations, the dataset became clean, consistent, and ready for creating interactive dashboards and performing cybersecurity incident analysis.

5: Data Preprocessing

The dataset was cleaned by handling missing values, removing duplicate records, correcting data types, and preparing the data for accurate analysis and visualization.

Source

- Imported the cybersecurity incident dataset into Power BI.

Promoted Headers

- Converted the first row of the dataset into column headers.

Changed Data Types

- Assigned appropriate data types (Text, Number, Date) to each column for accurate analysis.

Removed Unnecessary Columns

- Deleted irrelevant columns that were not required for the analysis to improve performance.

Renamed Columns

- Renamed column headers to meaningful and easy-to-understand names.

Capitalized Each Word

- Standardized text values by converting them into proper case for consistency.

Replaced Values

- Replaced invalid, missing, or inconsistent values (such as **NA** or unwanted values) with appropriate values.

Cleaned Text

- Removed non-printable and unwanted characters from text fields.

Trimmed Text

- Eliminated leading and trailing spaces to ensure consistent text formatting.

Filtered Rows

- Removed unwanted rows and retained only valid records required for analysis.

Reordered Columns

- Rearranged the columns into a logical sequence to improve readability and simplify data processing.

Sorted Rows

- Sorted the dataset to organize records in a structured order.

Final Validation

- Verified the cleaned dataset to ensure data accuracy, consistency, and readiness for dashboard creation.

6: Data Modeling

The cleaned, fully numeric dataset was imported into Power BI as a single optimized table, with correct data types assigned to every column and DAX measures written to support interactive analysis (Total Incidents, Threat Level).

After preprocessing, the cleaned dataset was imported into Power BI for data modeling. The processed dataset contains 10,228 records and 21 columns, making it suitable for creating an efficient analytical model. Since the project uses a single processed dataset, a single-table data model was adopted to simplify analysis and improve dashboard performance.

6.1 Data Model Structure

The data model consists of one optimized table containing all cybersecurity incident information.

6.2 Data Type Configuration

Before visualization, all columns were assigned appropriate data types within Power BI.

Data Type	Example Columns
Whole Number	incident_id
Text	action, actor,victim_country
Decimal Number	asset.total_amount

6.3 DAX (Data Analysis Expressions) Measures

To support interactive dashboard analysis, DAX measures were created.

-> Total Incidents = COUNT(result[incident_id])

-> Threat Level = IF(COUNT(result[incident_id]) > 1000,"CRITICAL","NORMAL")

7: Data Visualization

After building the data model, interactive visualizations were created in Power BI to analyze cybersecurity incidents and present meaningful insights. Different visual types were selected to represent trends, comparisons, geographic distributions, and key performance indicators.

Seven dashboards were designed and built to cover different analytical angles — **Executive Summary, Threat Analysis, Attacker and Actor Intelligence, Target and Asset Vulnerability Analysis, Impact and Incident Severity, Threat Pattern Deep Dive and Attack Pattern Analysis** — each combining KPI cards, charts, maps, and slicers.

Dashboard 1: Executive Summary



1.1 Total Incidents

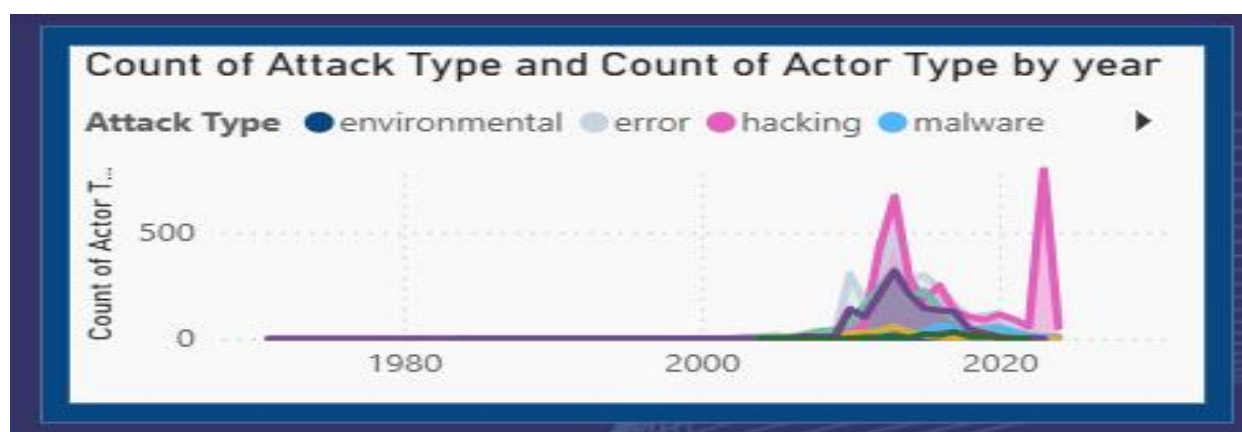
A KPI card displays the total number of cybersecurity incidents (10K). It provides an immediate overview of the incident volume and serves as the primary performance indicator of the dashboard.

1.2 Average Incidents

A KPI card displays the average number of incidents as 330. This provides an understanding of the average incident volume and helps summarize the overall distribution of cybersecurity incidents in the dataset.

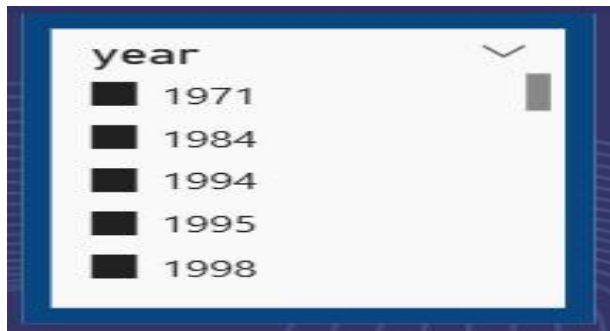
1.3 Total Countries

A KPI card displays that incidents were reported across 141 countries, highlighting the global nature of cybersecurity threats.



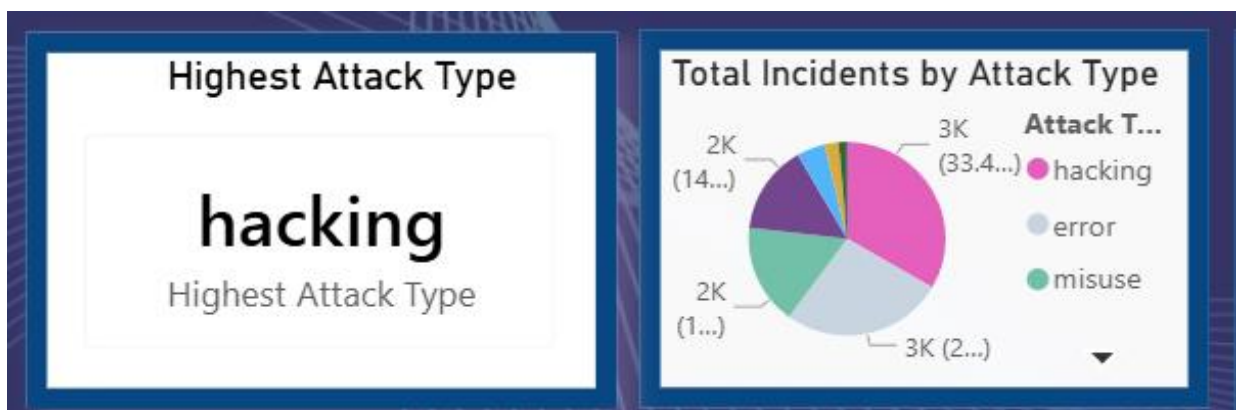
1.4 Attack and Actor Trend by Year

A combined chart illustrates the yearly trend of cybersecurity incidents based on attack types and actor types. The chart shows that incidents remained relatively low in the earlier years, followed by a significant increase after the 2000s, with major peaks during the 2010–2020 period. This helps analyze how different attack categories and actors contributed to the growth of cyber incidents over time.



1.5 Year slicer

An interactive Year slicer allows users to filter the dashboard based on a specific year or a range of years. When a year is selected, the other visuals update dynamically to display cybersecurity incidents for the selected time period. This enables users to analyze changes in attack types, incident counts, targeted countries, and global threat distribution over different years.

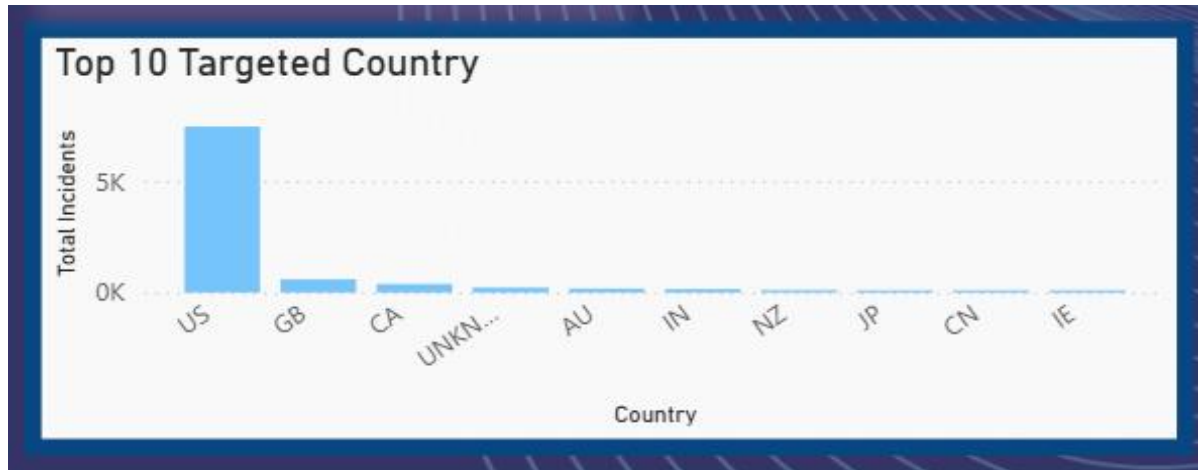


1.6 Highest Attack Type

Highlights the attack type with the highest number of incidents in the dataset, allowing users to quickly identify the most common cybersecurity threat.

1.7 Total incidents by Attack Type

Shows the distribution of incidents across different attack types. It helps compare the proportion of each attack category and identify the most prevalent threats.



1.8 Top 10 Targeted Countries

A vertical bar chart ranks the countries with the highest number of cybersecurity incidents. The United States records the highest number of incidents, followed by other countries, while the "Unknown" category indicates incidents with unidentified locations.

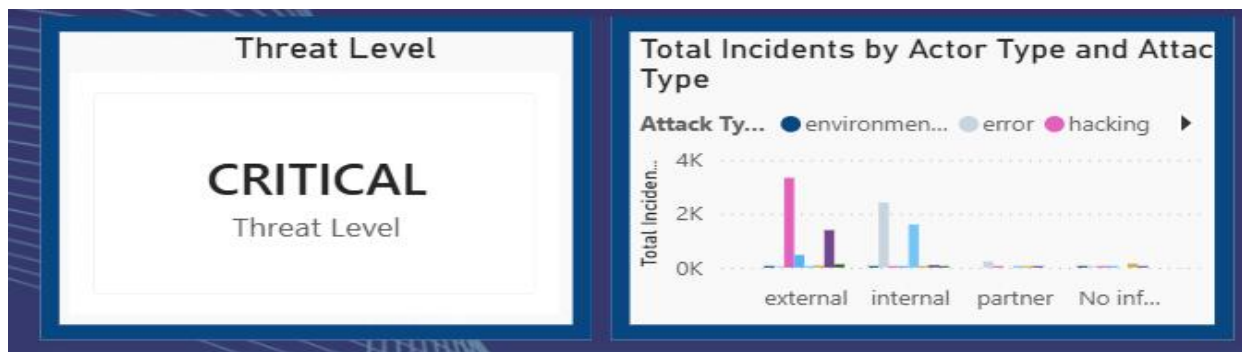


1.9 Global Threat Distribution

A bubble map visualizes the geographical distribution of cybersecurity incidents worldwide. Larger bubbles represent regions with higher incident counts, making it easier to identify global threat hotspots.

Dashboard 2: Threat Analysis

The Threat Analysis page provides detailed insights into attack behaviour, threat actors, motives, and historical trends.

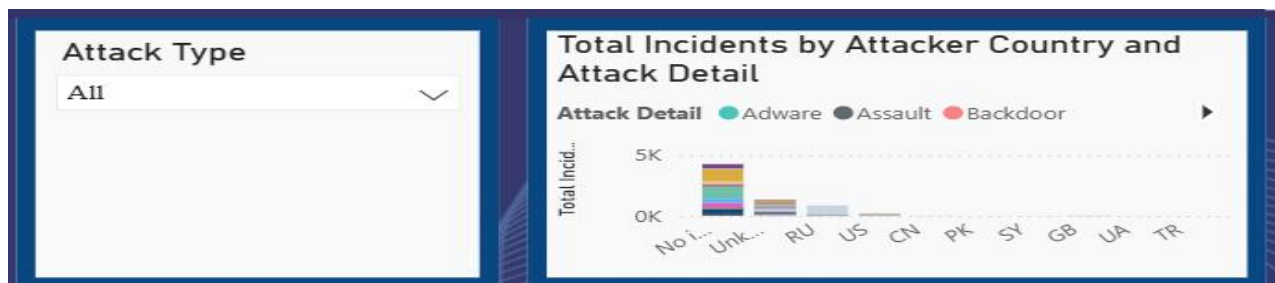


2.1 Threat Level

A KPI card displays the overall Threat Level as Critical, indicating the severity of the cybersecurity incidents analysed in the dataset and highlighting the importance of monitoring and analysing these threats.

2.2 Actor Type vs Attack Type

A grouped bar chart compares attack types across External, Internal, Partner, and Unknown actors. External actors account for the highest number of incidents, while internal and partner-related threats also contribute significantly.

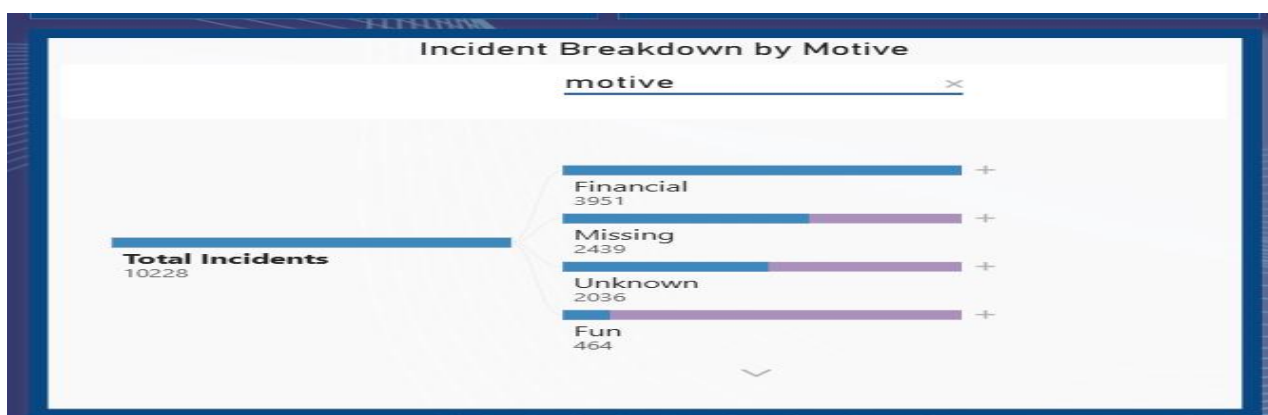


2.3 Attack Type Slicer

An interactive slicer enables users to filter the dashboard by attack type. Selecting a specific category updates all visuals dynamically, allowing focused analysis.

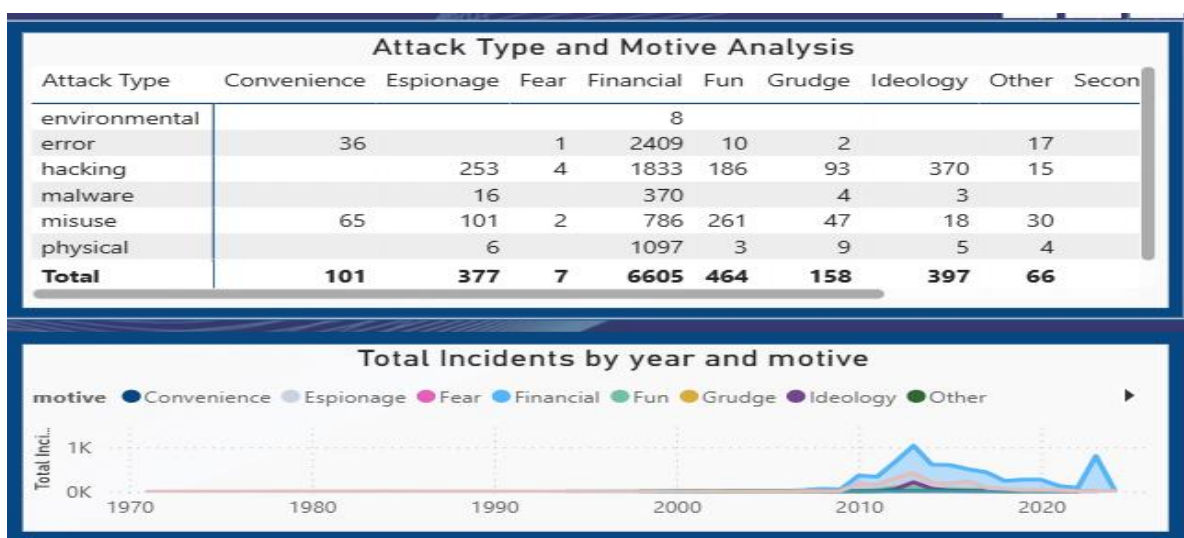
2.4 Incidents by Attacker Country

Displays the total number of cybersecurity incidents by attacker country, categorized by attack details. This visualization helps identify the countries associated with higher attack activity and compare the distribution of different attack details.



2.5 Decomposition Tree

The decomposition tree breaks down total incidents into individual attack categories, allowing users to drill down into detailed information and perform interactive analysis.



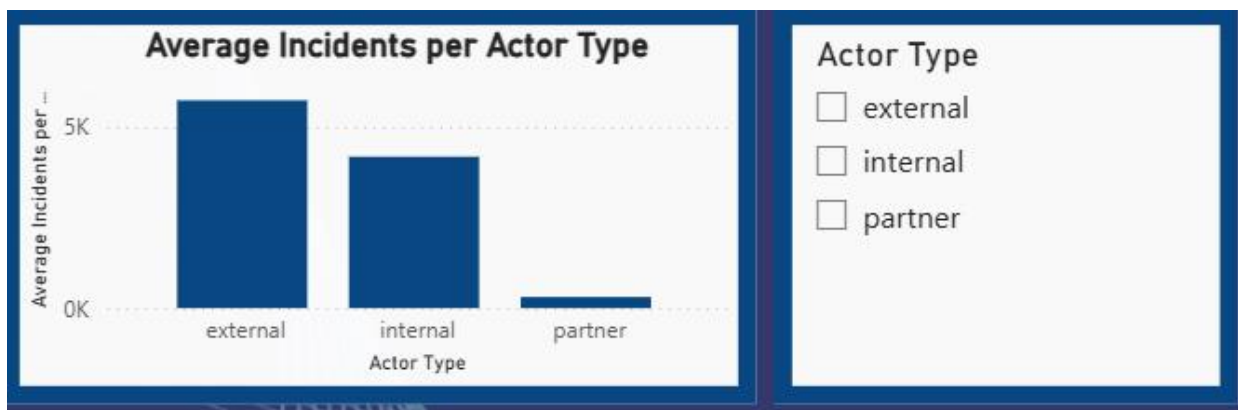
2.6 Attack Type vs Motive Matrix

A matrix visual compares attack types with attacker motives. Financially motivated hacking records the highest number of incidents, followed by financially motivated physical attacks, highlighting the primary drivers behind cyber threats.

2.7 Incident Trend by Motive

A stacked area chart displays the trend of cybersecurity incidents over time based on attacker motives. The chart shows a steady increase in incidents after 2005, with significant growth after 2010, demonstrating the rising complexity and frequency of cyber threats.

Dashboard 3: Attacker and Actor Intelligence



3.1 Average Incidents per Actor Type

Displays the average number of cybersecurity incidents for each actor type, helping compare the level of activity among external, internal, partner, and unknown actors.

3.2 Actor Type

Allows users to filter the dashboard by a selected actor type, enabling focused analysis of incidents associated with specific actors.



3.3 Actor Type

Displays the selected actor type based on the slicer, providing a quick summary of the current dashboard filter.

3.4 Count of Incident ID by Actor Description

Shows the distribution of cybersecurity incidents based on actor descriptions. The size of each block represents the number of incidents, making it easy to identify the most common attacker categories.

Top Attacker Origins																				
Actor Type	AF	AL	AM	AR	AT	AU	AZ	BD	BE	BG	BR	BZ	CA	CL	CN	CO	DE	DK	EE	EG
external	2	1	1	7	1	11	2	4	2	3	5	3	19	1	62	1	2	1	1	
internal			1			1							2		7					1
partner																				
Total	2	1	2	7	1	12	2	4	2	3	5	3	21	1	69	1	2	1	1	1

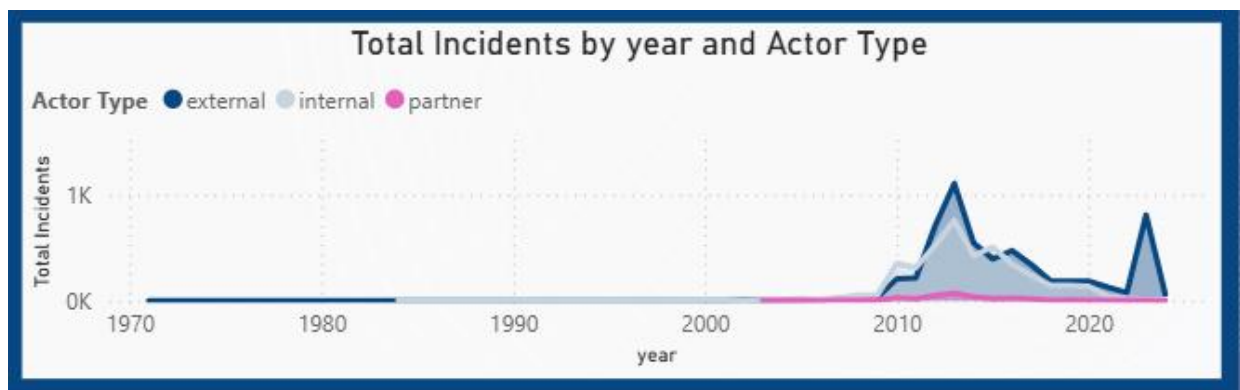
3.5 Top Attacker Origins

Displays the distribution of actor types across different attacker countries, helping identify the primary origins of cybersecurity incidents.



3.6 Attacker Country

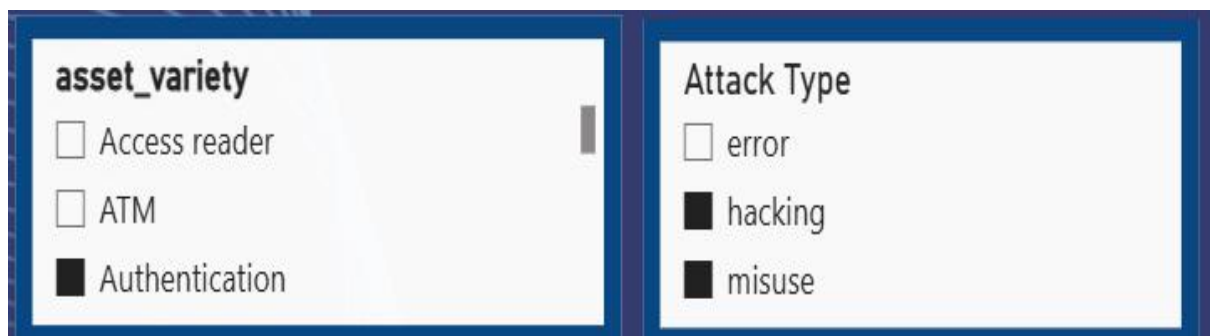
Visualizes the geographical locations of attacker countries, providing a global view of where cybersecurity incidents originate.



3.7 Total Incidents by Year and Actor Type (Area Chart)

Illustrates the yearly trend of cybersecurity incidents for different actor types, helping users analyze how attacker activity has changed over time.

Dashboard 4: Target and asset Vulnerability Analysis



4.1 Asset Variety Filter: Allows users to filter the analysis based on asset types such as Authentication, ATM, and Access Reader.

4.2 Attack Type Filter: Provides filtering based on attack categories such as hacking, misuse, and error.



4.3 Asset Type Targeting Trend by Year: Shows how frequently the selected asset type was targeted from 2012 to 2018. The highest targeting was observed around 2014, followed by a decline.



4.4 Asset Environment Distribution by Asset Type: Displays the distribution of attack incidents across different years and attack types. Hacking appears as a major attack type.

4.5 Most Common Attack Detail: Identifies Brute Force as the most common attack detail in the selected data.

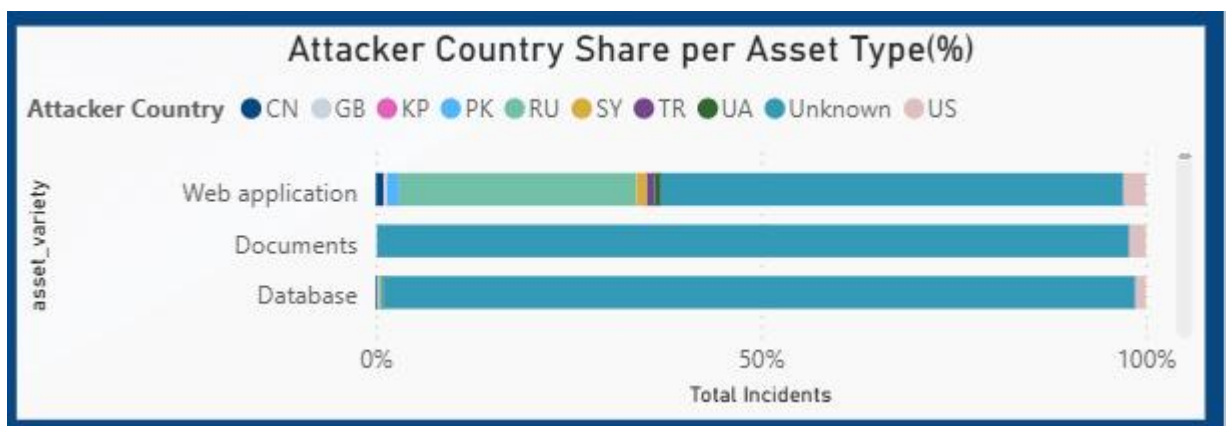
Asset Type vs Attacker Motive Intelligence Matrix						
asset_variety	Convenience	Espionage	Fear	Financial	Fun	Grudge
Access reader				2		
ATM				220	2	
Authentication		2		6		
Backup				10		
Broadband		1		1		
Total	101	377	7	6605	464	151

4.6 Asset Type vs Attacker Motive Matrix: Shows the relationship between the asset type and attacker motives such as Espionage, Financial, No Information, and Unknown.



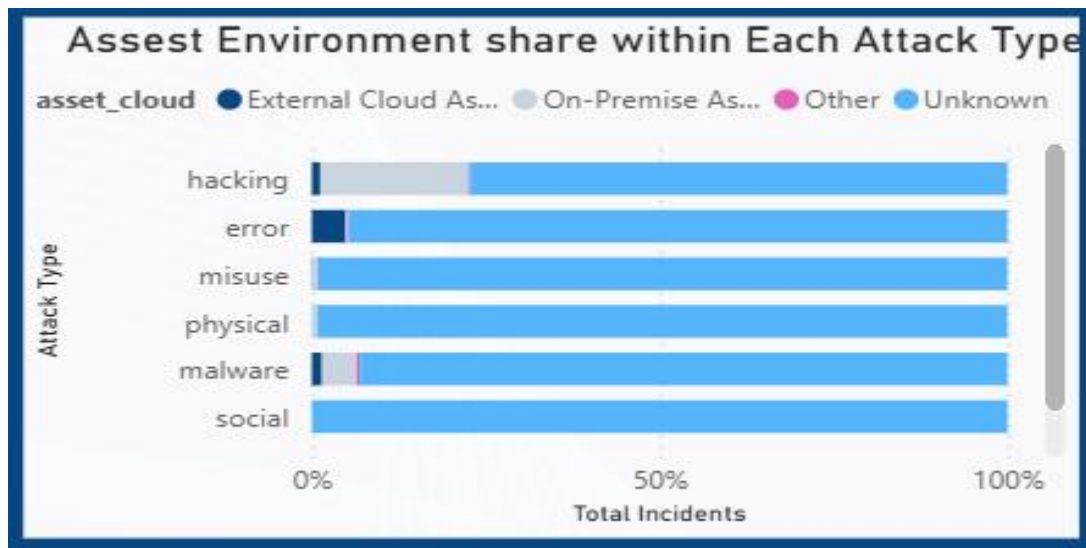
4.7 Attack Motivation by Asset Environment: Represents the percentage distribution of attacker motives. A significant portion of the incidents has an Unknown motive.

4.8 Total Unique Asset Varieties: Shows 7 unique attack types in the selected dataset.



4.9 Attacker Country Share per Asset Type: Compares the contribution of known and unknown attacker countries for the selected asset. The visualization shows a large share of incidents associated with Unknown attacker information.

Dashboard 5: Impact and incident Severity



5.1 Asset Environment Share within Each Attack Type

Displays the percentage distribution of asset environments across different attack types, helping identify which environments are most affected by cybersecurity incidents.

5.2 Total Incidents by Attack Detail

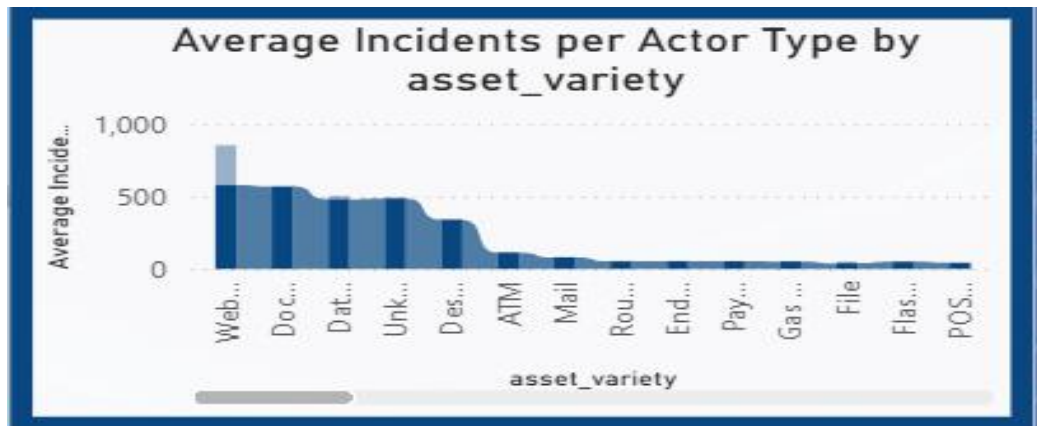
Shows the total number of incidents for each attack detail, helping identify the most frequently occurring attack methods.

5.3 Most Targeted Asset Types

Highlights the asset types that experience the highest number of cybersecurity incidents, making it easy to identify the most targeted assets.

5.4 Filter by Attack Type

Allows users to filter the dashboard based on the selected attack type for focused analysis.



5.5 Average Incidents per Actor Type by Asset Variety

Displays the average number of incidents for each actor type across different asset varieties, enabling comparison of attack activity.

5.6 Cloud vs On-premise Asset Incidents

Compares the total number of incidents affecting cloud, on-premise, and other asset environments to evaluate their impact.

5.7 Year-over-Year Growth Rate

Displays the annual percentage change in cybersecurity incidents, indicating the growth or decline in attack frequency.



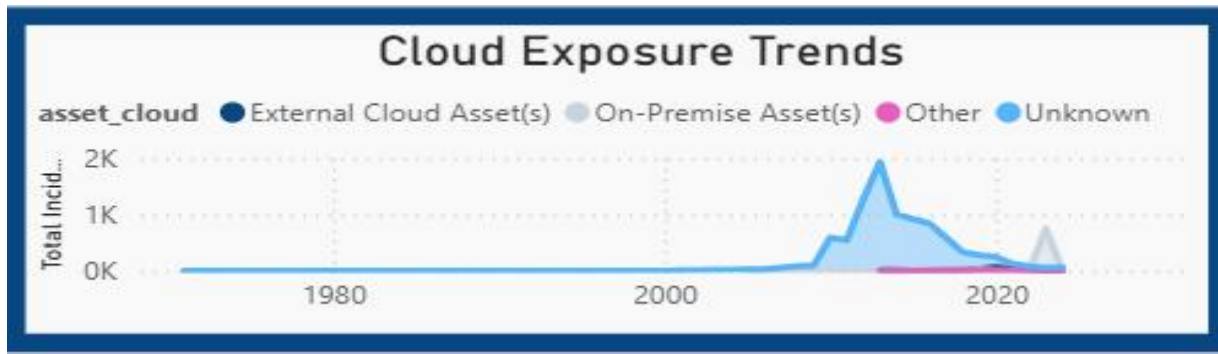
5.8 Total Incidents by Month

Shows the monthly trend of cybersecurity incidents, helping identify periods with higher or lower attack activity.

Dashboard 6: Threat Pattern Deep Dive

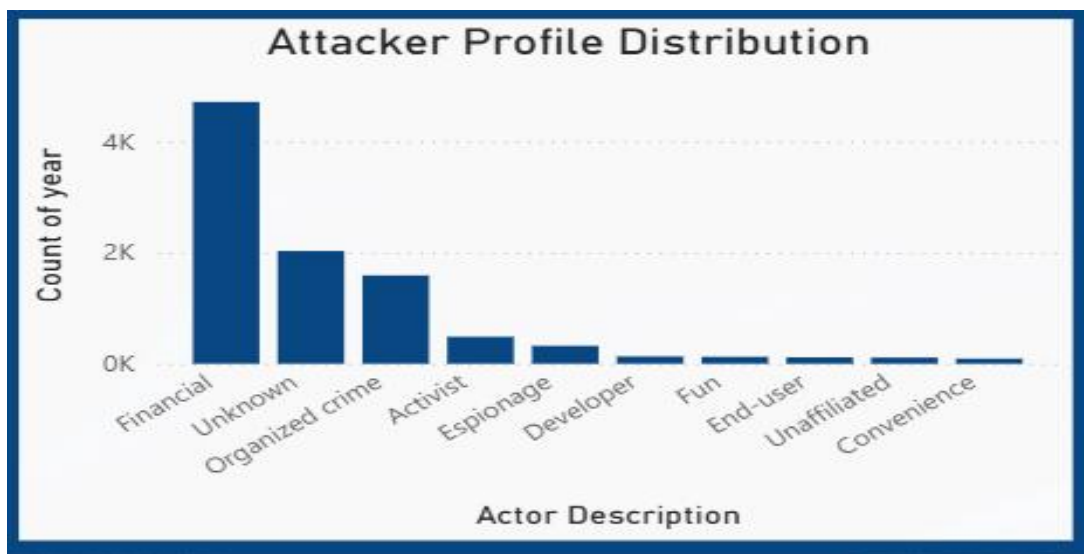
6.1 Peak Threat Year

Shows 2013 as the most dangerous year, indicating the highest level of recorded threat activity.



6.2 Dominant Attack Motive

Missing is the most common motive, showing that the reason behind many attacks was not recorded or available.

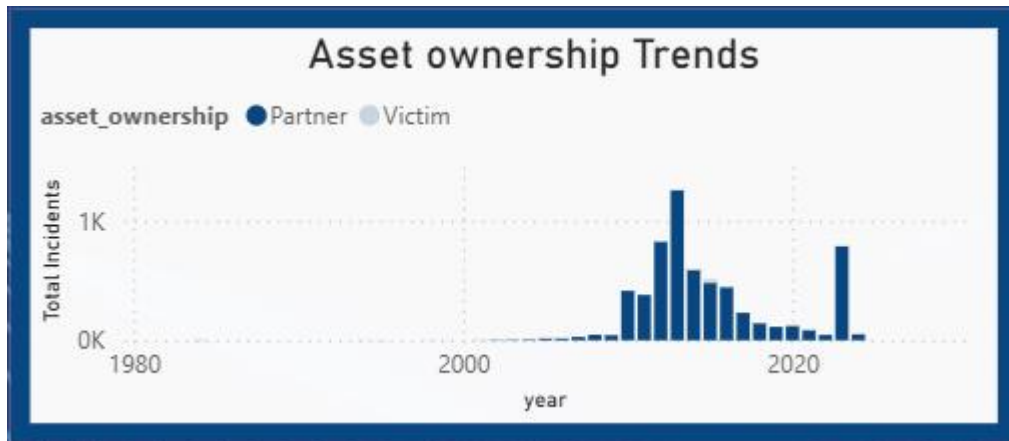


6.3 Most Targeted Asset

Documents are identified as the most targeted asset, indicating that document-related resources were frequently involved in the recorded incidents.

6.4 Cloud Exposure Trends

Shows changes in cloud-related exposure over time. The graph indicates a significant rise in exposure during the later years, followed by a decline.



6.5 Asset Ownership Trends

Shows the distribution of asset ownership categories such as Missing, No Information, Partner, and Victim across different years. Missing ownership information is prominent.

6.6 Attacker Profile Distribution

Shows the distribution of attacker profiles. Missing and Unknown attacker descriptions have the highest counts, followed by Activist and Espionage.

6.7 Asset Management Threat Exposure

Compares attack types across asset management categories. The No Information category has the highest number of incidents, with hacking and other attack types contributing significantly.

6.8 Motive Filter

Allows users to filter the dashboard based on motives such as Convenience, Espionage, Financial, Fun, Grudge, Ideology, and Missing.

6.9 Country Filter

Allows users to select individual countries and analyse the cybersecurity threats associated with the selected country.

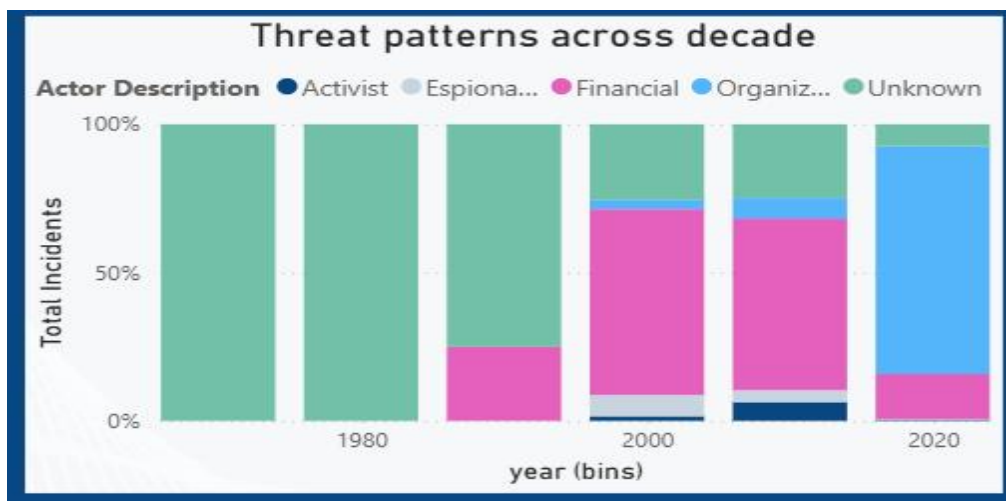
Dashboard 7: Attacker Patter Analysis

7.1 Threat Activity Span

Shows a total activity span of 31 years based on the available incident records. It helps understand cybersecurity threats across different time periods.

7.2 Peak Threat Decade

The 2010s recorded the highest threat activity, showing a significant increase in cyber incidents during this period.



7.3 Threat Patterns Across Decades

Shows changes in attacker descriptions across different decades. Unknown and Missing attacker information forms a major portion of the records.

7.4 Threat Motive Trend

Shows how attack motives such as Espionage, Financial, Convenience, Fear, Fun, Grudge, and Ideology varied over time.



7.5 Threats by Asset Hosting

The No Information category has the highest number of incidents, indicating that hosting environment details were unavailable for many records.

7.6 Attack Technique Over Time

Shows the use of different attack techniques across the years. Attack activity increased significantly during the 2010s, with several techniques becoming more common.



7.7 Most Targeted Asset Role

No Information is the most frequently recorded asset role, followed by IT. This shows that detailed information about the targeted asset role was missing in many incidents.

8: Share / Publish Report

The completed analysis, interactive dashboards, and data preprocessing methodology were systematically compiled into this milestone report to provide a comprehensive overview of the project. The report documents each stage of the workflow, including problem understanding, data collection, preprocessing, data modelling, and visualization, ensuring that all project activities are clearly explained and reproducible.

This milestone report serves as a complete reference document for mentor evaluation and project assessment. The final report ensures knowledge transfer, maintains project continuity, and supports future research and decision-making in the field of cybersecurity analytics.

6. Snapshots / Screenshots

1) Data Preprocessing

	incident_id	action	action_variety	motive	actor	actor_variety
1	EB7AA5C3-382D-462F-8EE5-C55C726F7...	error	Publishing error	NA	internal	NA
2	6f2f9bf0-e962-11eb-9aea-07892f56ef76	malware	Ransomware	Financial	external	Organized crime
3	CA42F0F9-7DAC-418F-BD54-67AEC34CB...	error	Misdelivery	NA	internal	NA
4	02a64550-0a3f-11ea-9821-617d71ee6253	hacking	Unknown	Unknown	internal	End-user
5	EF551307-9876-4F7F-B6C3-A478A2F913...	error	Publishing error	NA	internal	NA
6	7019DB5A-D535-4C68-9FCC-DE62087BD...	misuse	Possession abuse	Financial	internal	Financial
7	95ACEA3B-7F6-437A-96D6-DED71DAD...	physical	Tampering	Financial	external	Organized crime
8	F6D4FE67-8416-4C14-A9C7-7FD8CEEDE...	hacking	Exploit vuln	Unknown	external	Activist
9	7CF99F57-175C-4E15-9240-735A3B19B9...	error	Loss	NA	partner	NA
10	3A742F30-39E2-4CCF-86FD-29015A6D7...	physical	Theft	Unknown	external	Unknown
11	7F3A71FF-1FC3-4389-B275-809A61B1EF...	error	Misdelivery	NA	internal	NA
12	2CBF8964-F1B4-4A3E-9DE5-4D39A405A...	physical	Theft	Financial	external	Financial
13	3D5AEF06-501B-4D6F-A167-A73526BE...	misuse	Privilege abuse	Unknown	internal	Unknown
14	ACA6A6EC-7C0D-4E2D-9554-A12F40907...	hacking	Exploit vuln	Financial	external	Organized crime
15	D9D71FA3-5EB1-492A-91E7-8570C97B1...	hacking	Unknown	Ideology	external	Activist
16	03FE096E-1995-4745-92C6-4B03198934...	hacking	Exploit vuln	Financial	external	Organized crime
17	B2D0220F-50A2-4FD8-B882-27343F480...	hacking	Exploit vuln	Financial	external	Organized crime
18	12cd65e0-0279-11e9-ae0f-7420d4f5238	hacking	Unknown	Unknown	external	Unknown
19	a8fdb420-b210-11e8-800d-891a5c02ea18	error	Publishing error	NA	internal	NA
20	63C77F22-82F6-4A7F-AB6D-A8378B616...	hacking	Unknown	Unknown	external	Unknown

Fig:1.1 Removed Column

The Unnamed: 0 column was removed because it was an automatically generated index column and did not contribute to the cybersecurity analysis. Its removal helped simplify the dataset and improve data quality.

	actor	actor_variety	asset_cloud	external_actor_country	month	year
1	internal	NA	Unknown	Unknown	8	2016
2	external	Organized crime	Unknown	Unknown	5	2020
3	internal	NA	Unknown	Unknown	3	2013
4	internal	NA	Unknown	Unknown	2	2013
5	partner	NA	Unknown	Unknown	7	2011
6	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	12	2013
7	internal	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	6	2023
8	external	Organized crime	On-Premise Asset(s)	RU	9	2013
9	external	Activist	Unknown	Unknown	4	2010
10	internal	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	11	2013
11	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	1	2002
12	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	10	2013
13	external	Activist	Unknown	TR		

Fig:1.2 Removed Duplicates

Missing values present in the dataset were identified using the Column Quality feature in Power Query Editor. Columns containing empty values were examined, and missing entries were replaced with "Unknown" to maintain data consistency and avoid information loss during analysis.

Query Settings

Query Formula: = Table.TransformColumnTypes("#Removed Duplicates1",{{"year", Int64.Type}, {"month", Int64.Type}})

	A _C actor	A _C actor_variety	A _C asset_cloud	A _C external_actor_country	1 ₂ month	1 ₂ year
	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	54% Valid 0% Error 46% Empty	92% Valid 0% Error 8% Empty
1	internal	NA	Unknown		null	2016
2	external	Organized crime	Unknown	Unknown	8	2020
3	internal	NA	Unknown		5	2013
4	internal	NA	Unknown		3	2013
5	partner	NA	Unknown		2	2013
6	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	7	2011
7	internal	Unknown	Unknown		12	2013
8	external	Organized crime	On-Premise Asset(s)	RU	6	2023
9	external	Activist	Unknown	Unknown	9	2013
10	internal	Unknown	Unknown		4	2010
11	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	11	2013
12	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	1	2002

APPLIED STEPS

- Source
- Promoted Headers
- Removed Columns
- Removed Duplicates
- Removed Duplicates1
- Changed Type
- Replaced Value

Fig:1.3 Changed types

The data types of all attributes were validated and standardized. Numerical columns such as month and year were converted to whole numbers, while categorical columns were retained as text to support accurate analysis and visualization.

Query Settings

Query Formula: = Table.TransformColumnTypes("#Removed Duplicates1",{{"year", Int64.Type}, {"month", Int64.Type}})

	A _C actor	A _C actor_variety	A _C asset_cloud	A _C external_actor_country	1 ₂ month	1 ₂ year
	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty	54% Valid 0% Error 46% Empty	100% Valid 0% Error 0% Empty
	internal	NA	Unknown		0	2016
	external	Organized crime	Unknown	Unknown	8	2020
	internal	NA	Unknown		5	2013
	internal	NA	Unknown		3	2013
	partner	NA	Unknown		2	2013
	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	7	2011
	internal	Unknown	Unknown		12	2013
	external	Organized crime	On-Premise Asset(s)	RU	6	2023
	external	Activist	Unknown	Unknown	9	2013
	internal	Unknown	Unknown		4	2010
	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	11	2013
	external	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	1	2002
	external	Activist	Unknown	TR	10	2013

APPLIED STEPS

- Source
- Promoted Headers
- Removed Columns
- Removed Duplicates
- Removed Duplicates1
- Changed Type
- Replaced Value

Fig: 1.4 Replaced Value

Missing (null) values in the dataset were replaced with 0 using the Replace Values feature in Power Query Editor. This was done to handle incomplete records, maintain data consistency, and facilitate accurate analysis and visualization.

2) Data Modelling



3) Data Visualisation

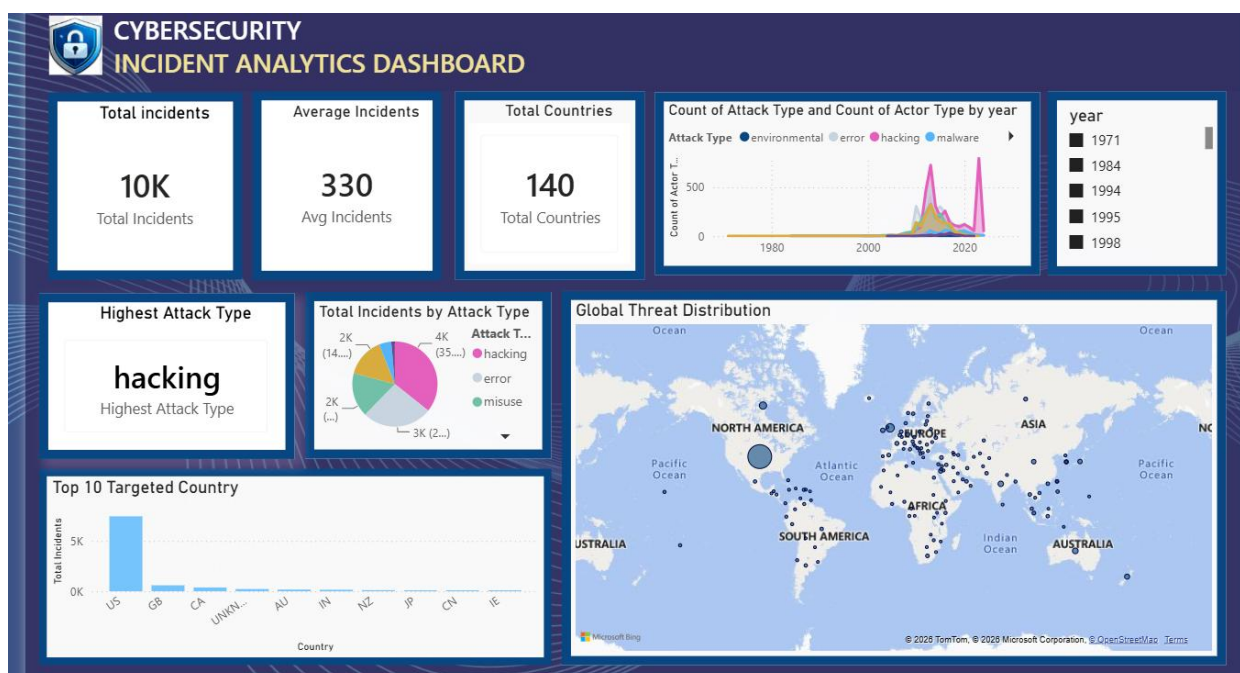


Fig : 3.1 Executive Summary



Fig : 3.2 Threat Analysis

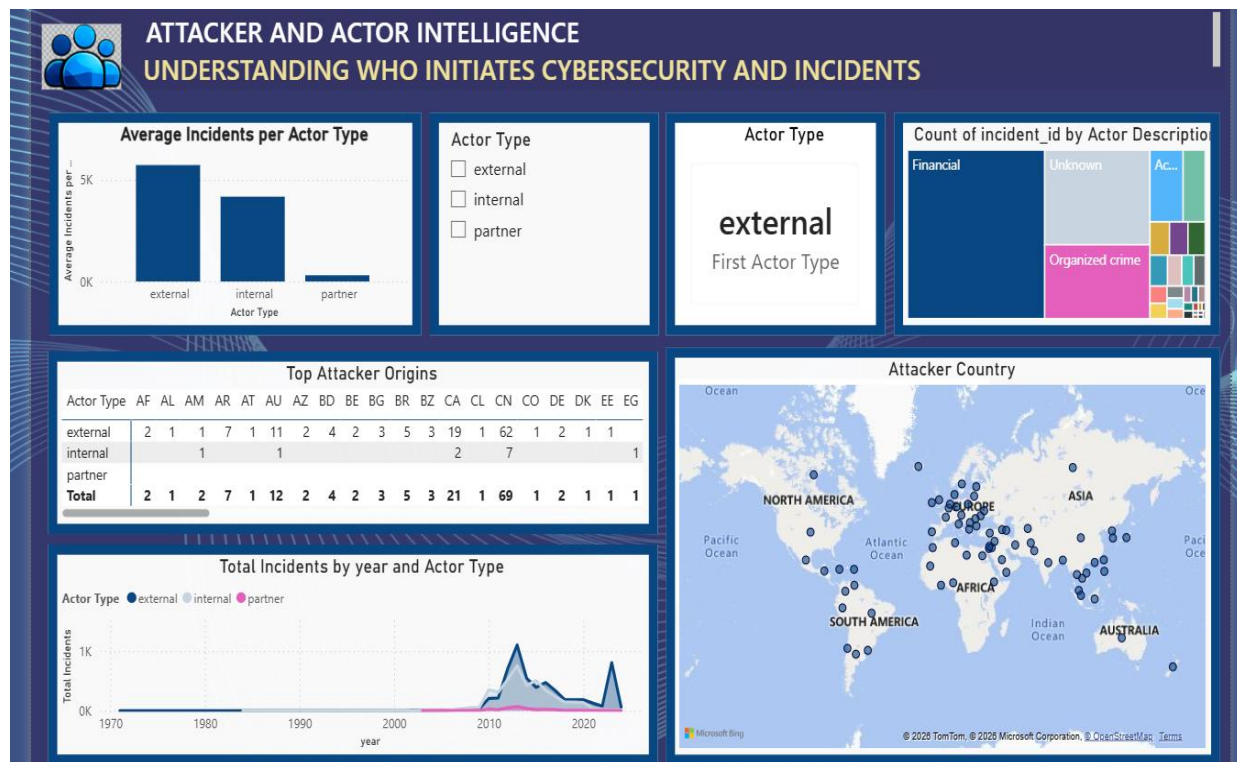


Fig: 3.3 Attacker and actor Intelligence

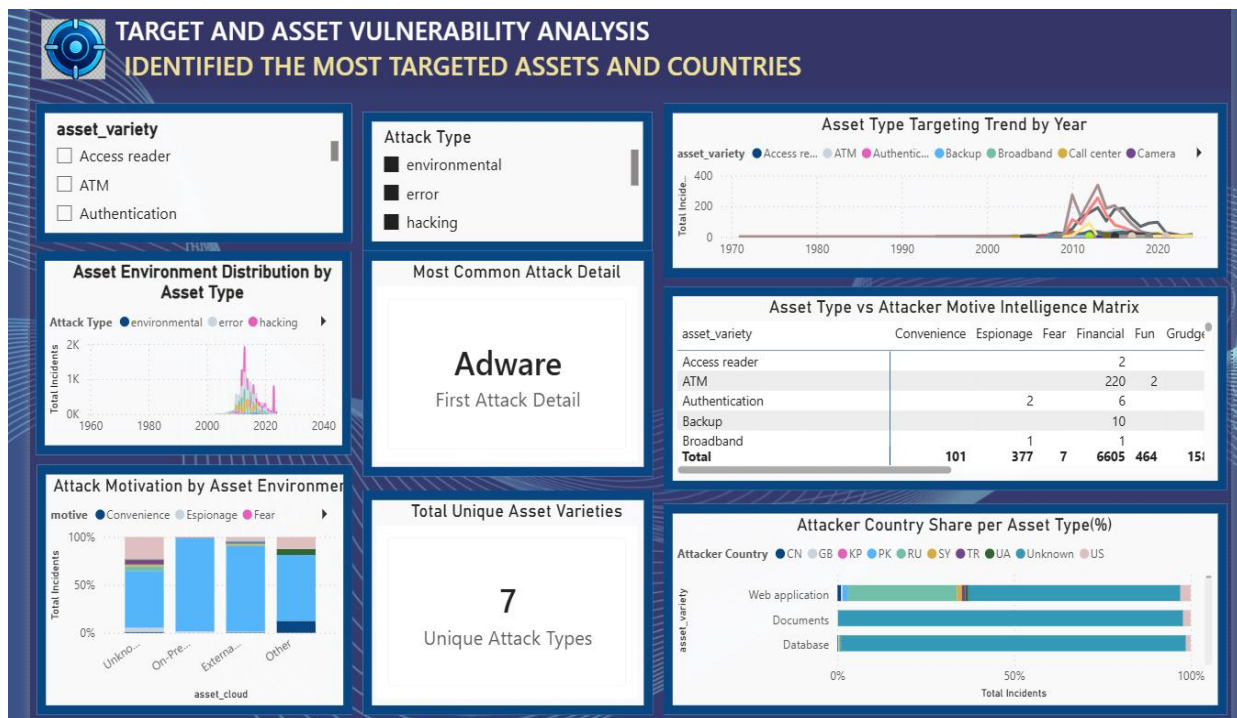


Fig : 3.4 Target and asset Vulnerability Analysis

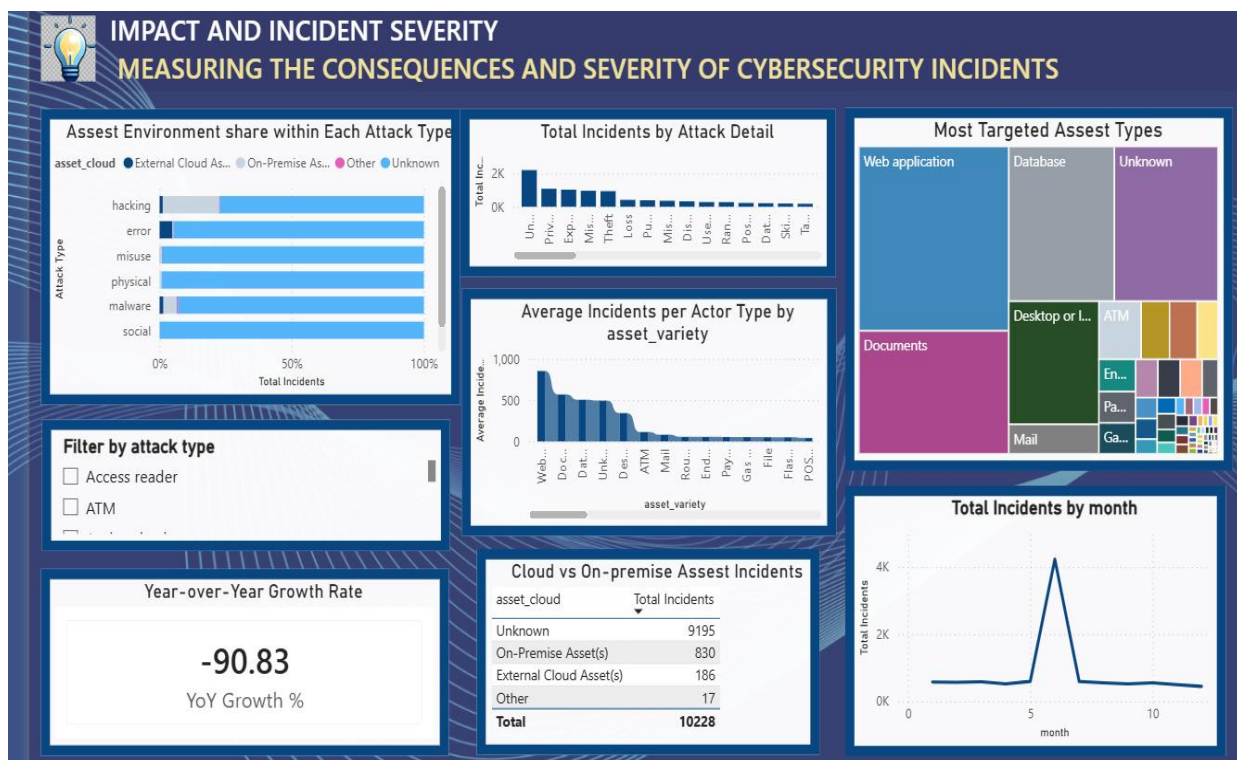


Fig : 3.5 Impact and incident Severity

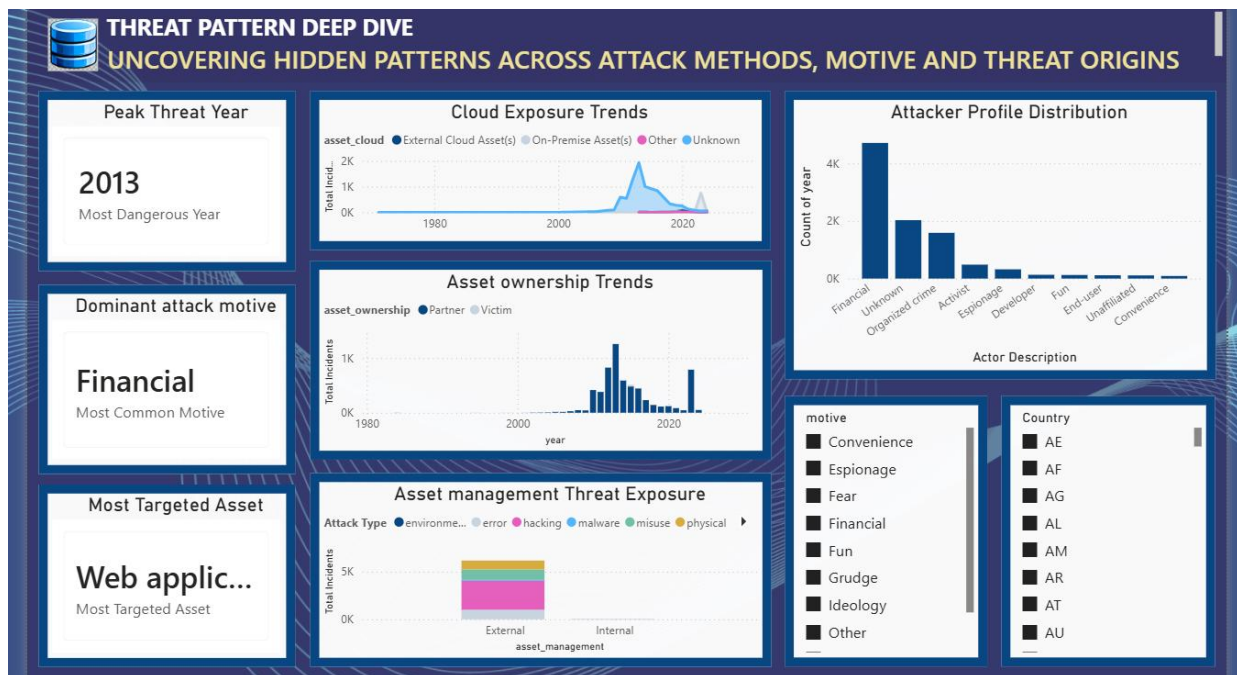


Fig : 3.6 Threat Pattern Deep Drive

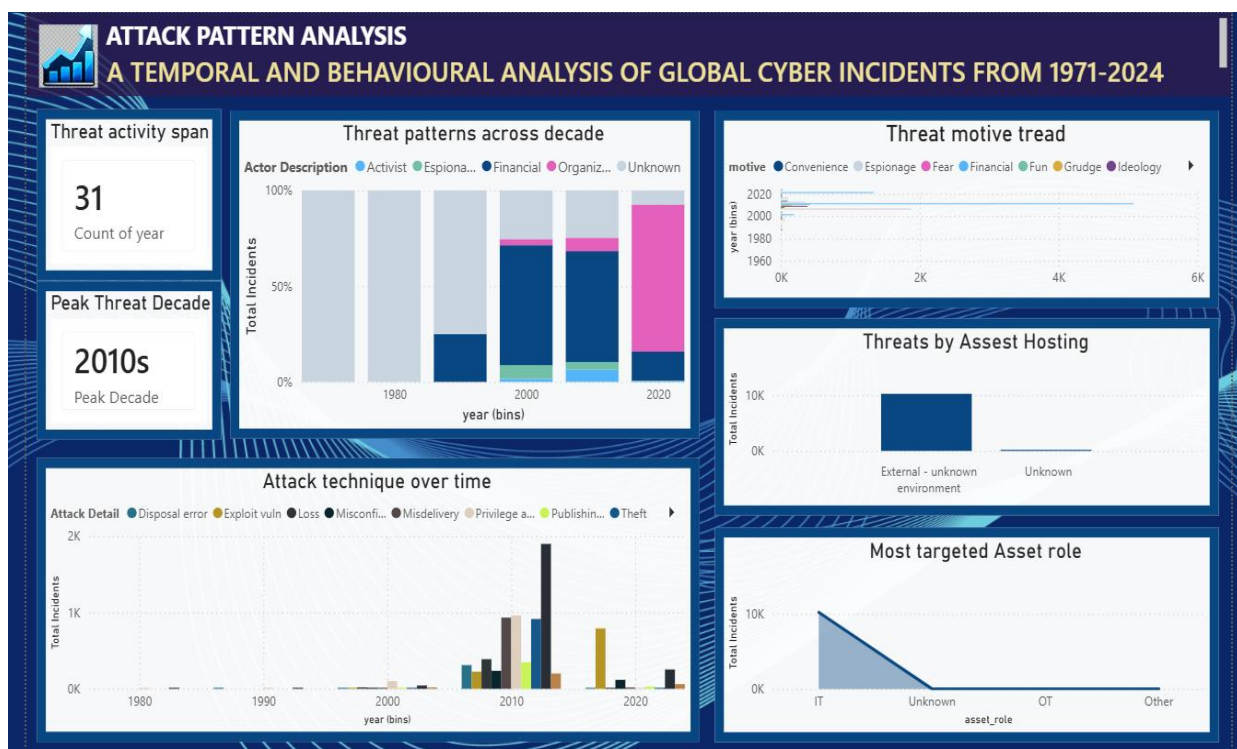


Fig: 3.7 Attack Pattern Analysis

7. Challenges Faced

- **Understanding the cybersecurity dataset** – Initially, understanding the large dataset structure, different attributes, and their relationships was challenging. This was resolved by studying the column descriptions and identifying the attributes most relevant to cybersecurity analysis.
- **Selecting appropriate visualizations** – Choosing suitable charts for different types of cybersecurity information was challenging. Different visualization types were tested and the most meaningful ones were selected to clearly represent trends and comparisons.
- **Creating DAX measures** – Developing calculated measures such as total incidents, averages, and other KPIs required understanding basic DAX functions. This was overcome through practice, testing, and checking the results against the dataset.
- **Designing multiple dashboards** – Creating several dashboards without repeating the same information was challenging. Different themes such as threat patterns, attack techniques, asset targeting, attacker profiles, and motives were used to make each dashboard unique.
- **Ensuring data accuracy** – Dashboard values were checked against the original dataset to ensure that calculations and visualizations were correct. Filters, DAX measures, and chart interactions were also tested before finalizing the dashboards.
- **Managing dashboard layout** – Arranging multiple charts, slicers, cards, and tables in a limited dashboard space required several adjustments. The layout was refined to improve readability and make important information easy to identify.

8. Learnings & Skills Acquired

8.1 Technical Skills

- Developed interactive dashboards using **Microsoft Power BI**.
- Gained hands-on experience with **Power Query** and **DAX**.
- Created interactive visualizations using charts, maps, and KPI cards.

8.2 Analytical and Problem-Solving Skills

- Analyzed cybersecurity data to identify trends and patterns.
- Improved problem-solving through data preprocessing and dashboard design.
- Enhanced data-driven decision-making skills.

8.3 Future Enhancements

- Integrate real-time cybersecurity data.
- Implement predictive analytics using machine learning.
- Add automated alerts and advanced dashboard features.

8.4 Soft Skills and Team Collaboration

- Improved communication and documentation skills.
- Strengthened time management and analytical thinking.
- Learned to incorporate mentor feedback effectively.

8.5 Domain Knowledge and Application

- Gained knowledge of cybersecurity incidents and attack trends.
- Understood the role of Power BI in cybersecurity analytics.
- Learned the importance of data visualization for decision-making.

9. Testimonials from Team

Vennala Pathipaka — Data Collection & Preprocessing

This project provided extensive exposure to cybersecurity data analytics and preprocessing techniques. Working with more than 10,000 incident records helped us understand the challenges associated with real-world datasets. In addition, analyzing data distributions, identifying data quality issues, and implementing appropriate preprocessing strategies enhanced our understanding of how reliable datasets form the foundation for effective cybersecurity analysis.

Twinkle Mohanty — Data Modeling & DAX Measures

Contributing to data modelling and Power BI development allowed us to gain practical experience in business intelligence and data visualization. Designing relationships, creating DAX measures, and building an efficient data model enhanced our understanding of analytical frameworks. The project improved our ability to convert raw data into actionable insights that support informed decision-making. Furthermore, developing KPIs, calculated columns, and interactive filters strengthened our problem-solving skills and deepened our understanding of data relationships.

Subhashree Subhasmita — Dashboard Design & Visualization

Developing interactive dashboards enabled us to explore cybersecurity incidents from multiple perspectives, including threat patterns, attacker behavior, geographical distribution, and asset vulnerabilities. Creating visualizations and implementing filters and slicers improved our dashboard-design skills and demonstrated how data visualization can simplify complex information. The project also enhanced our ability to select appropriate visual representations for different types of data and helped us understand the importance of user-friendly dashboards in communicating insights effectively.

Maddula Tejasri Lakshmi — Geographic & Asset Analysis

Focusing on the analysis and interpretation of cybersecurity incidents helped us understand the importance of data-driven security strategies. The project improved our ability to identify patterns, extract meaningful insights, and apply analytical techniques to real-world cybersecurity challenges. Additionally, studying geographical distributions, asset vulnerabilities, and incident severity enabled us to understand how cyber threats vary across different regions and asset categories.

10. Conclusion

This project successfully transformed a raw cybersecurity incident dataset into a clean, structured, and analysis-ready dataset through systematic data preprocessing, data modeling, and interactive visualization in Power BI. The preprocessing phase improved data quality by handling missing values, encoding categorical attributes, scaling numerical features, and validating the processed dataset while preserving all 10,228 incident records. The cleaned dataset was then organized into an optimized single-table Power BI data model, supported by DAX measures that enabled efficient calculations and interactive analysis.

Key Outcomes

- **Improved Data Quality:** Missing values were handled appropriately, categorical data was encoded, and numerical features were standardized, resulting in a complete and reliable dataset for analysis.
- **Efficient Data Modeling:** An optimized single-table Power BI data model with DAX measures enabled faster calculations, simplified report development, and improved dashboard performance.
- **Comprehensive Interactive Dashboards:** Multiple dashboards combining KPI cards, charts, maps, matrices, slicers, and treemaps provided detailed insights into attack trends, threat levels, attacker intelligence, targeted assets, geographical distribution, and incident severity.
- **Actionable Security Insights:** The visualizations help identify dominant attack types, attacker behavior, vulnerable assets, high-risk regions, and evolving cyber threats, supporting data-driven cybersecurity strategies and resource prioritization.
- **Scalable Analytics Framework:** The complete workflow — from data collection and preprocessing to modeling and visualization — provides a scalable foundation for future cybersecurity monitoring, reporting, and advanced analytics.

11. Acknowledgements

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to the Infosys Springboard Team for organizing this highly enriching virtual internship program and for providing a structured, industry-aligned learning platform. The well-designed modules, milestone-based framework, and practical orientation of the internship enabled us to gain meaningful exposure to real-world business intelligence applications.

We extend our heartfelt appreciation to our mentor, Mrs. Nithyasree, for her consistent guidance, valuable feedback, and continuous encouragement throughout the project lifecycle. Her insights and structured direction played a significant role in shaping the analytical depth and professional quality of this project.

We would also like to acknowledge our team members for their strong collaboration, accountability, and shared commitment toward achieving project objectives. The coordinated distribution of responsibilities, open communication, and collective problem-solving approach significantly contributed to the successful execution of this project.

In addition, we extend our appreciation to the creators and maintainers of Microsoft Power BI documentation and community resources, which served as essential references during dashboard development and KPI implementation. We are also grateful to Kaggle for providing access to publicly available datasets that facilitated practical, hands-on analytical experience.

The structured learning resources and practical exposure provided through this internship have significantly strengthened our analytical thinking, technical proficiency, and business interpretation skills. This experience has enhanced our ability to approach data with a strategic mindset, collaborate effectively within a team environment, and execute projects with professional discipline.

Overall, this internship has been a meaningful milestone in our academic and professional journey, reinforcing the value of data-driven decision-making and structured analytical execution in modern business environments.